Deep Delta

Indicators & Analysis / Deep Indicators | intermediate | 4 min read | DeepCharts Help Center | August 24, 2026

Deep Delta is an advanced evolution of the classic Delta Bars indicator. Instead of one delta number per candle, it lets you apply size filters to the delta and split it into up to four separate ranges — so you can watch small, medium and large participants' delta independently inside the same candle.

That separation is the whole point: retail-sized flow and institutional-sized flow often disagree, and Deep Delta makes the disagreement visible.

What it is

Delta is aggressive buying volume minus aggressive selling volume. Classic delta lumps every trade size together; Deep Delta's Multi-Range mode filters trades by size into up to four ranges (each with its own minimum and maximum) and plots each range's delta as its own series. Threshold lines and vertical markers flag the moments when delta extremes hit levels you define.

When to use it

- You want to see whether large players agree with the current move — or are fading it.
- You want to strip out small-lot noise and read only size above a threshold.
- You look for absorption: strong delta pushes in one direction that price fails to follow.
- You already use Delta Bars and want the same reading with size context added (Delta Bar covers the classic version).

Quick start

1. Open a chart and add **Deep Delta** from the chart's **Indicators** button.
2. Set **Delta Mode** to **Multi-Range**.
3. Enable two ranges to start: one with a low minimum for small flow, and one with a high **Min** filter (and **Max** = 0, which disables the maximum) for large flow only.
4. Set **Input Data** to **Aggregate Trades** so split executions are recombined before filtering — otherwise a large order counted as many small fills lands in the wrong range.
5. Apply, and give each range a distinct color in the **Subgraph** section.

The live demo below shows the underlying reading — per-bar delta with the cumulative delta line. Hover any bar for its story.

[WIDGET: delta-lab]

How to read it

- **Ranges agree** (all positive or all negative): participation is aligned across sizes — the pressure is broad.
- **Ranges diverge**: the interesting case. For example, large-size delta (a range with Min = 50) positive while small-size delta is negative suggests big players are buying into retail selling.
- **Markers firing while price does not follow the delta push**: the aggression is being absorbed by passive orders — a classic warning that the move may stall or reverse. See Understanding Icebergs and Absorption.
- **Threshold lines**: your own significance levels — delta beyond the line means the bar's aggression is unusual by your definition.

For the underlying bid/ask/aggressor mechanics, see Orderflow 101: Bid, Ask, Aggressor and Delta.

Settings reference

Grouped as in the indicator dialog.

Parameters

Setting	What it does
Delta Mode	**Classic** (standard Delta Bars, no filters) or **Multi-Range** (activates the filtered delta ranges)
Input Data	Calculation basis: **Volume** (total traded volume at each price level — high-intensity zones), **Aggregate Trades** (trades combined at the same price level — reduces execution-fragmentation noise), **Trades** (number of transactions per level — trade frequency), **Order** (order data such as buy/sell order quantities — order pressure). See Different Types of Input Data for Indicators
Range 1–4	Each range has a **Min** filter, a **Max** filter and an enable toggle. Setting Max to 0 disables the maximum filter

Threshold

Setting	What it does
Level-settings	Up to two customizable horizontal lines at defined positive/negative delta levels
Marker	Vertical markers when both the minimum and maximum deltas reach a set threshold — highlights opposing delta pushes within a single bar and absorption situations

Subgraph

Setting	What it does
Range colors	A color per enabled range
Maximum Positive/Negative Delta shadows	Shadow colors marking each bar's delta extremes
Line Thickness	Adjusts the delta range body and shadow appearance

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Deep Delta settings dialog open at the Parameters section showing Delta Mode set to Multi-Range and the four range rows with Min/Max filters `dc-en-deep-delta-01.png`

Tips and common mistakes

- **Nothing plots in Multi-Range mode?** The ranges must be individually enabled, and the Min/Max filters must not exclude everything — remember Max = 0 disables the maximum, so check whether your Min sits above the delta sizes actually trading. Also confirm the Input Data choice.
- **Want only big players' delta?** One enabled range with a high Min filter, and **Input Data** = **Aggregate Trades** so split executions are recombined into their original size first.
- **Ranges look identical?** Your Min/Max boundaries may overlap heavily — make the size bands distinct (for example 1–9, 10–49, 50+).
- **Markers everywhere?** The threshold is too low for the instrument's typical delta. Raise it until markers flag genuinely unusual bars.
- Delta measures aggression, not outcome — always read it against price. Strong positive delta with no upward progress is a bearish observation, not a bullish one.

Related articles

- Delta Bar

- Orderflow 101: Bid, Ask, Aggressor and Delta
- Deep Print (Footprint)
- Understanding Icebergs and Absorption
- Different Types of Input Data for Indicators
- How to Change the Layout of Indicators